

Travis Reed Mendoza

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Portfolio: <https://travis-mendoza.github.io/digital-garden/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

End-to-end engineer with startup execution experience across robotics, AI applications, and hardware systems. Builds products from concept through deployment, combining technical depth with customer-facing communication.

EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager, El Milagro Project (High Degree) | Baja California, Mexico | 2026

- Trained and supervised local farmworkers to operate steam treatment equipment safely and effectively.
- Led land preparation operations that steamed 25 acres before planting organic strawberries.
- Coordinated field execution to reduce weed and disease pressure prior to planting.

Founding Engineer | EyeZense (Stealth Startup) | Silicon Valley, CA | 2024-2026

- Built IoT and AI robotics systems end-to-end, including planning, procurement, assembly, programming, and validation.
- Developed robotic software and controls using C++, Python, and ROS 2 across sensing and autonomy workflows.
- Served as a technical lead in fundraising demos and pitch materials that supported a \$15M seed round.

Full-Stack Mobile Developer | Cohost | 2023-2025

- Built a promptless virtual assistant using Swift and SwiftUI with a Django backend.
- Integrated LLM-driven features into user-facing workflows and backend services.
- Designed and shipped full-stack mobile and server-side features in a rapid prototype environment.

Customer-Facing Test Engineer | Skyloom | 2022-2024

- Translated customer requirements into verification and validation matrices for optical communication systems.
- Designed, built, and executed hardware test campaigns for laser communication prototypes.
- Delivered demo-ready test outcomes that supported milestone payments and contract growth.

Owner's Engineer | Surf Cove | 2016-2019

- Designed and tested prototype wave-generating machinery for engineered surf environments.
- Led technical development from concept design through physical testing iterations.
- Relocated to Mexico to support project deployment planning and became fluent in Spanish.

Mechanical Engineering Intern | NASA | 2013 & 2015

- Designed and prototyped docking interface components for Astrobee, the ISS free-flying robot.
- Contributed to both robot-side and dock-side design to support autonomous docking and recharging.

EDUCATION

M.S., Mechanical Engineering | University of California, Berkeley | 2020-2021

GEM Fellow

- Thesis: Position, Navigation, and Timing architecture concepts for the Earth-Moon corridor.

- Completed two summer internships at The Aerospace Corporation.

B.S., Mechanical Engineering | University of Southern California | 2012-2016

SKILLS

Python, C++, ROS 2, Swift, SwiftUI, Django, Robotics, IoT Systems, AI Product Development, Hardware Prototyping, Test Engineering, Verification and Validation, Technical Demos, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Spanish (Fluent)